

Appliances and Optional Systems

Texas Real Estate Commission Standards of Practice · **22 TAC 535.232 and 535.233** · For the TREC state exam (25 questions, pass at 75%)

Two sections with opposite logic. Appliances are *required* and each gets its own subsection. Optional systems are *only inspected if you agree to* — and that agreement is itself the examinable point.

535.232 Appliances — nine subsections

- General Provisions
- Dishwasher
- Food Waste Disposers
- Range Hood and Exhaust Systems
- Electric or Gas Ranges, Cooktops and Ovens
- Microwave Ovens
- Mechanical Exhaust Systems and Bathroom Heaters
- Garage Door Operators
- Dryer Exhaust Systems

Texas inspects appliances. The national standard largely does not. This whole section is close to unique to the state exam, so it is worth disproportionate attention for 25 questions.

Two specific numbers from the rule

- **Gas appliance connectors:** report as Deficient a connector that **exceeds six feet in length**, and one that is **concealed within or extends through** walls, floors, partitions, ceilings or appliance housings.
- **Oven thermostat accuracy:** deficient if not **within 25 degrees at a setting of 350°F**.

The six-foot connector rule also appeared on your national practice exams. Here it comes with its partner rule: a connector must never be concealed or pass through a partition.

Garage door operators

Operation, auto-reverse and the photoelectric sensors. This is a life-safety item, and Texas requires you to test it rather than merely observe it.

535.233 Optional Systems — six subsections

- **(a)(b)** Limitations and Scope
- **(c)** Landscape Irrigation (Sprinkler) Systems
- **(d)** Swimming Pools, Spas, Hot Tubs and Equipment
- **(e)** Outbuildings
- **(f)** Private Water Wells
- **(g)** Private Sewage Disposal (Septic) Systems

The defining rule: these are inspected **only if the inspector agrees to inspect them**. They are not part of a standard inspection. But once you agree, the rule for that system applies in full — you cannot agree and then inspect casually.

Private water wells — what the rule actually requires

- Report the **type of pump and storage equipment** and the **proximity of any known septic system**
- Report as Deficient: **water pressure and flow** and pressure switch performance; the condition of accessible equipment; and the **well head**, including improper site drainage and clearances
- Not required to open or remove components, determine the reliability of the supply, or locate underground leaks

Septic systems

Report the **type of system** and the **location of the drain or distribution field**.

Pools and spas — what you need NOT determine

The effectiveness of **entrapment covers**, the presence of **shell or sub-surface leaks**, or ancillary equipment such as computer controls, covers, chlorinators and water ionisers.

Notice the pattern across every optional system: **report the type, report visible deficiencies, and determine nothing that requires digging, dismantling or testing.**

Check Yourself

1. When are optional systems inspected?

Only if the inspector agrees to inspect them. Then the full rule for that system applies.

2. Two deficiencies for a gas appliance connector?

Longer than six feet, or concealed within or extending through a wall, floor, partition, ceiling or appliance housing.

3. Oven thermostat tolerance?

Within 25 degrees at a setting of 350°F.

4. Must you determine whether a pool entrapment cover is effective?

No. That is expressly excluded.

Content follows the official TREC Standards of Practice, 22 TAC 535.227-535.233. Rules are amended periodically — verify against the current version on trec.texas.gov before the exam.